



INDIAN SOCIETY

MODULE - 10

STRUCTURAL CHANGE-URBANIZATION AND SLUMS

URBANIZATION IN INDEPENDENT INDIA

- 1 Population residing in urban areas in India, according to 1901 census, was 11.4%
- 2 Urbanisation in India has progressed at snail's pace. It rose from 17.3% in 1951 to 31.2% in 2011. This is just 2.3% increase per decade.
- 3 Even during the fast growth phase of 2001-11, India added only 3.4% to urbanization.
- 4 In 2017, the numbers increased to 34%, according to the World Bank.
- 5 Urban centres in India have not been able to emerge as magnets for good jobs for rural masses on a scale seen in South Korea and China.



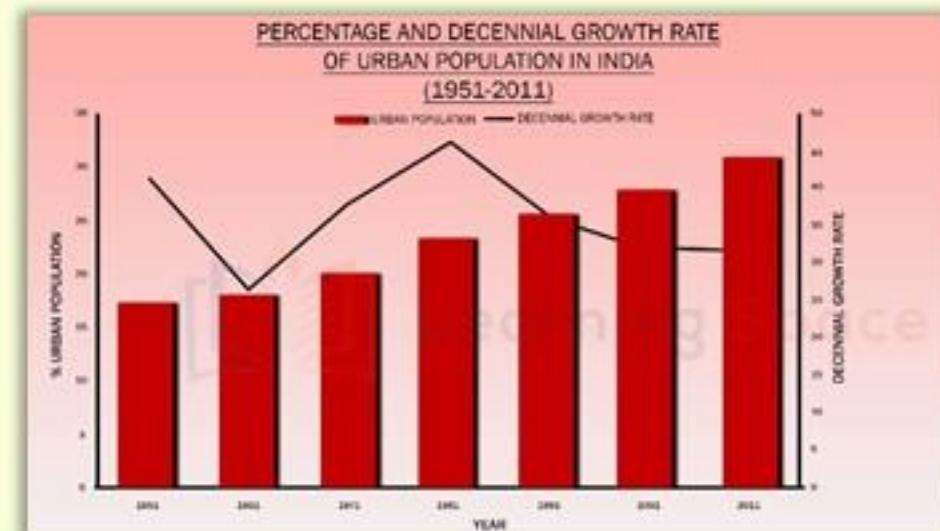
URBANIZATION IN INDEPENDENT INDIA

6 The first chart indicates that the urban population and the number of UA/Towns in India are increasing.

7 The second chart indicates that the per cent share of the urban population is increasing but decennial growth rate of the urban population shows a decreasing trend.

8 This shows a steady increase in terms of absolute numbers, number of UA/towns and the per cent share of the urban population.

9 However, the decennial growth rate of the urban population showed a declining trend during 1981-2001, reversed the trend and showed marginal increase in 2011.



URBANIZATION IN INDEPENDENT INDIA

10 The decennial growth rate of the urban population in 1951 was 41.42% and in 2011, it was 31.80%.

11 For the first time since Independence, the absolute increase in population is more in urban areas than in rural areas. This is due to a sharp decline in the growth rate in rural areas, while the growth rate in urban areas remains almost the same.

12 This urbanization process in independent India is haphazard than dispersed and orderly.



The census of India, 2011 defines urban settlement as :-

1 All the places which have municipality, corporation, cantonment board or notified town area committee. All the other places which satisfy following criteria :

- a** A minimum population of 5000 persons
- b** At least 75 % of male main working population engaged in non-agricultural pursuits
- c** A density of population of at least 400 persons per square kilometre

FACETS OF URBAN AREAS





2 Urbanisation involves 3 aspects:

- a** **Demographic & Spatial aspects:** shift of people from rural to urban areas.
- b** **Economic aspects:** change from agricultural to non-agricultural occupations
- c** **Socio-cultural aspects:** emerging heterogeneity in urban areas. Cities are generally meeting points of cultures and races.



URBAN AREAS

SPATIAL PATTERN

1 Over urbanisation

a Bombay and Calcutta are such cities, where population growth is beyond their capacities to manage.

b Problems of pollution, Traffic, unavailability of accommodation, Drinking water, sewage and sanitation, women safety, new forms of crime, Lifestyle diseases

2 Sub urbanisation: When towns get over crowded, surrounding areas get urbanised. ex. NCR.



URBAN AREAS

ECONOMIC ASPECT

- 1 Urbanisation is a natural and inevitable consequence of economic development. Occupational diversification and migration are key features.
- 2 Unemployment among educated classes in urban areas is a peculiar feature in Indian society
- 3 Around 46% of total educated unemployed are reportedly in 4 major metropolitan cities.



SOCIO-CULTURAL ASPECT

- 1 Towns and cities have achieved heterogeneous character in terms of ethnicity, caste, race and class
- 2 However, studies show that though various ethnic, caste groups have adjusted to live with each other, they have also maintained their traditional identity.
- 3 Migrants tend to cluster around people with whom they have linguistic, regional, caste and ethnic ties.



SOCIO-CULTURAL ASPECT

4 Pavement dwellers often retain close ties with kinship and caste groups for socializing and transmitting or receiving information from village.

5 In many Indian cities, especially in trade cities like Agra, neighbourhoods have remained homogeneous in terms of caste and religious groups.

6 In planned cities like Chandigarh, neighbourhood hasn't developed on the basis of such identities.



- 1 Nuclear families increase with urbanisation. But studies have shown that joint families do continue to exist in cities among certain castes.
- 2 Changes in family structure such as reduction in family size; delegation of certain traditional functions of family such as educational, recreational, etc. to outside institutions; relative equality in status and rights of women.
- 3 Studies also indicate that new concept of wifehood, i.e., emphasis on conjugal relationship in India is associated with urban living.
- 4 New forms of families like live in relations, co-habitation, same sex families like LGBTQ emerging
- 5 There is no sharp cultural discontinuity between kinship org of countryside and urban areas.



CASTE IN URBAN INDIA

- 1 Urban studies have shown that caste continues to play an important role in urban areas.
- 2 As far as occupation is concerned, they follow secular rules but in personal and family matters maintain caste identities. Dichotomy between professional and personal space.
- 3 Higher caste doesn't always correlate with higher class. This difference is most often found in cities where new job opportunities have developed.
- 4 Caste seems to have become a basis for trade-union like associations. Ex. Gujarat Bania Sabha, Kshatriya Mahasabha, Jatav Mahasabha etc.
- 5 Rules of commensality have little significance in urban centres today. Ex. people freely eat out in restaurants, etc.



1 Census 2001 defines slum as a compact area of at least 300 population or about 60-70 households of poorly built congested tenements, in unhygienic environment usually with inadequate infrastructure and lacking proper sanitary and drinking water facilities.

2 According to Census 2001, there are 42.6 million people are found to live in slums all over the urban areas of the country. This constitutes 23% of the urban population.

3 Rural-urban migration is the major factor contributing to slums

- Poverty
- Social conflict and natural disasters like droughts etc
- Poor infrastructure, social exclusion and economic failure
- As per 2011 Census, 450 million migrant population constitute around 35% of total population .
- The effect of migration to urban areas are both positive and negative.



POSITIVES

- 1 Creates cultural pockets - Assimilation of different cultures - Exchange of traditions, customs - Emergence of multiculturalism
- 2 In the long run, creates "One India" with fusion of ideas/with transfer of thoughts, strengthening rational thinking, mobility of money/resources.

NEGATIVES

- 1 Insider-outsider syndrome - suspicion-hatred-regionalism
- 2 Sons of soil concept for political gains- perpetrated by regional parties
- 3 Discrimination/attacks, increased crime rate
- 4 In no one's territory-out of policy perspectives



FUNCTIONS OF THE SLUMS

- 1** Provide housing for the lowest income groups and migrants in the city.
- 2** Serve as places where group living and association on the basis of villages, regions, tribes or ethnic or racial groups may develop
- 3** Function as a type of “School” to educate newcomers to the city. It gives them a place to become oriented upon arrival, to find first jobs and to learn the ways of city life.
- 4** Offering a place of residence to those who prefer to live an anonymous life. Which includes migratory workers, criminals, chronic alcoholic and workers in illegal enterprises.



APPROACHES TO THE SLUM PROBLEMS / SLUM REFORMS

1 Clearance and redevelopment with subsidized housing.

Criticism:

- a** Will make cities more attractive and the number of poor rural people arriving in cities will become difficult to handle.
- b** So the only way to reduce urban slum areas is to raise rural living standard to those of a city.
- c** Need education and motivation to orient residents to lead a better and organized way of life



APPROACHES TO THE SLUM PROBLEMS / SLUM REFORMS

2 Urban community development:

- Real problem is not the pervasive urban squalor that offends us all, but rather the moral and intellectual bankruptcy that sustains it.
- Need development of effective community feeling and self-help and citizen's participation.

Four main objectives:

1. Development of community feeling
2. Self-help improvement
3. Indigenous leadership
4. Cooperation between govt. and the people.

3 The 1958 Delhi pilot project in urban community development funded by Ford Foundation was reasonably successful.

4 Nationalisation of land in urban areas is also seen as a solution.



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